

SEO KPI Improvement Plan

Two-month performance review, root-cause diagnosis of the organic traffic gap, and a phased recovery roadmap for trocglobal.com.

trocglobal.com August 5, 2026 Source: Ahrefs API v3 (live snapshots) + direct site inspection

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Where we stand today

Organic traffic / mo

5,008

+52% vs. July

Traffic value / mo

\$521K

+20% vs. July

Ranking keywords

429

–17% vs. July

Keywords in Top 3

191

+11% vs. June

Domain Rating

43

+1 vs. June

Non-branded traffic

22%

Heavy brand reliance

Ahrefs shows an August rebound; Search Console does not yet confirm it.

Ahrefs estimates organic traffic rose 52% month over month, from 3,290 in July to 5,008, with Top-3 rankings **+11%** and Domain Rating **42 → 43** over two months. But Google's own data through July 23 shows **impressions down 51.8%** and **127 pages dropped from the index** — detailed below. The authority metrics are real; the traffic rebound is a model output awaiting verification.

The gap is longer-term. Traffic is still **21% below where it was a year ago** (6,336 → 4,986), and **the homepage alone accounts for 3,049 of 5,008 visits — 61%**, almost entirely from branded searches by people who already know T-ROC. Only **22% of traffic comes from non-branded searches**, meaning prospects who don't yet know us.

Two-month KPI comparison

Ahrefs snapshots taken on the 5th of each month for a like-for-like comparison.



Last month · July 5 → August 5, 2026

AHREFS KPI	JUL 5	AUG 5	CHANGE	READ
Organic traffic / mo	3,290	5,008	+52.2%	Strong rebound from the July low
Traffic value / mo	\$433K	\$521K	+20.2%	Recovered traffic is commercially valuable
Live backlinks	13,677	14,928	+9.1%	Volume up — but see quality note below
Referring domains	3,234	3,265	+1.0%	Growth slowing
Domain Rating	43	43	—	Held steady
Ranking keywords	519	429	-17.3%	July spike normalized
Keywords in Top 3	235	191	-18.7%	Same correction

The July anomaly is the most important number on this page

In July the site held **its highest-ever ranking counts — 519 keywords and 235 in the Top 3 — and its lowest traffic in twelve months (3,290)**. More top rankings produced less traffic. That combination is not normal, and it is the single strongest piece of evidence that **our rankings are not converting into clicks**. The root cause is identified in the next section.

Two-month trend · June 5 → August 5, 2026

AHREFS KPI	JUN 5	AUG 5	CHANGE	STATUS
Live backlinks	11,858	14,928	+25.9%	Quality concern
Keywords in Top 3	172	191	+11.0%	Improved
Referring domains	3,065	3,265	+6.5%	Quality concern
Ranking keywords	407	429	+5.4%	Improved
Organic traffic / mo	4,785	5,008	+4.7%	Improved
Domain Rating	42	43	+1	Improved
Traffic value / mo	\$525K	\$521K	-0.8%	Flat

Search Console contradicts the Ahrefs rebound — read this before acting on the numbers above

Google Search Console data through **July 23** shows **impressions down 51.8%** — from a June daily average of 16,051 to 7,738 — with **no recovery in the data available**. Over the same window Google **dropped 127 pages out of the index** (821 → 694), in two steps on June 30 and July 10.

Important context before reading this as damage: all **489 pruned pages had zero traffic**, and 279 of them now redirect correctly with no broken links or redirect chains. Removing zero-traffic pages is *supposed* to reduce impressions — those pages were appearing in search results without ever earning a click. Much of this decline may be the intended effect working as designed.

The decisive number is **clicks**, which this export does not contain. If clicks held steady while impressions halved, the consolidation succeeded and click-through rate roughly doubled. If clicks fell in proportion, real traffic was lost. **One Search Console export settles it.**

Until then, treat both the Ahrefs rebound and this impressions decline as **unconfirmed**, and do not present either as the outcome of the consolidation.

One caveat on the backlink growth

Backlinks rose 26% in two months, but this is **not a win**. An external spam network is generating links using domains that mimic ours. **84% of incoming link text is spam**. The growth is not earned and should not be reported as an achievement — it is a cleanup item, covered in Phase 4.

KEY FINDING

We rank #1 and receive no traffic

A cluster of merchandising pages ranks at or near the top of Google for **5,450 monthly searches** yet generates **zero traffic**:

PAGE	SEARCH TERM	VOL./MO	RANK	TRAFFIC
/merchandising-inventory/	what is merchandising	3,000	#1	0
/merchandising-services/	retail merchandising services	1,000	#6	0
/merchandising-e-commerce/	ecommerce merchandising	900	#1	0
/retail-merchandising/	what is retail merchandising	300	#1	0
/staff-scheduling-retail/	retail scheduling	250	#1	0

The cause: our page titles are cut off in Google

The system that generates the site's titles **truncates them at 50 characters** and then appends `- T-ROC`. The result is a title that reads as broken at the exact moment a searcher decides whether to click.

WHAT IT SHOULD SHOW

trocglobal.com > merchandising-inventory

WHAT GOOGLE SHOWS TODAY

trocglobal.com > merchandising-inventory

Understanding Merchandising Inventory: A Comprehensive Guide

Understand merchandising inventory management. T-ROC helps brands align product flow with demand...

Understanding Merchandising Inventory: A - T-ROC

Understand merchandising inventory management. T-ROC helps brands align product flow with demand...

Holding the #1 position with a title that looks broken destroys click-through. Measured across the **61 pages that currently rank**:

DEFECT FOUND	PAGES	EFFECT
Title cut off mid-sentence	12	Clicks lost on already-ranked results
Title tag completely empty	3	Google invents the title; we lose control of the message
Brand duplicated T-ROC - T-ROC	2	78-character title, truncated on screen
No H1 heading	8	Google can't identify the page's main topic

Verification required before we invest

This diagnosis rests on Ahrefs data, which **estimates** traffic using a model. Before committing significant effort we will confirm it against **Google Search Console**, which reports actual clicks. High impressions with near-zero clicks confirms the diagnosis; low impressions would mean the ranking data is stale and priorities change.

DIAGNOSIS

Five root causes

CAUSE	SEVERITY	STATUS
Broken page titles Cancel out click-through on pages that already rank	Critical	17 pages affected. Fixable in days.

CAUSE	SEVERITY	STATUS
Cloudflare is blocking crawlers Verified Aug 5: the site returns “you have been blocked”	Critical	Requested July 15. Open for 3 weeks.
H1 fix never deployed Code has been written and waiting since July 15	High	~293 pages. 5-minute activation.
Contaminated link profile External spam network using domains that mimic ours	High	84% of inbound link text is spam.
Indexation collapse 127 pages dropped from Google's index; only 39.6% of known pages indexed	Critical	465 crawled-not-indexed, 379 redirect pages failing validation, 90 404s.
Keyword targets lack volume We rank #1 on terms with 40–250 searches/mo	Strategic	Structural ceiling on growth.

On the strategic point: the site **can compete** — we hold #1 for “retail marketing services,” a high-difficulty term. The problem is that most of our top positions sit on very low-volume searches. Meanwhile “**brand ambassador**” (**18,000 searches/mo**) **has us at position #14**, with a dozen articles competing against each other and diluting the service page.

ROADMAP

Four-phase execution plan

Phases are ordered by dependency: Phase 0 unblocks everything else, and Phase 1 carries the highest return per hour of effort.

PHASE 0 Unblock	Blocks everything else	Week 1
• Cloudflare / WP Engine: allow Googlebot, Bingbot and AhrefsBot; review rate-limiting rules. <i>Requires the infrastructure administrator.</i> • Activate the H1 fix in WPCode — the code is already written.		

- **Lower the Ahrefs crawl rate** to clear false errors from the Health Score.
- **Validate the title diagnosis** against real Search Console click data.
- **Diagnose the 127 de-indexed pages** — identify which URLs left the index on June 30 and July 10, and whether the content consolidation removed pages that were still earning traffic.

PHASE 0.5 Recover the index

New — supersedes Phase 1 in priority

Weeks 1–3

- **Finish the consolidation** — it is only **57% done**. Of 489 pages marked for pruning, 279 were redirected but **210 are still live**. These are zero-traffic pages still being crawled, and they are the most likely source of the "crawled, not indexed" backlog.
- **465 pages "crawled, currently not indexed"** — Google saw them and declined. The largest single bucket, and a content-quality signal rather than a technical fault.
- **90 pages returning 404** — these are *not* from the prune list, which was verified clean with zero 404s. Their source needs identifying.
- **21 pages where Google chose a different canonical** than we specified.
- Re-submit for validation and monitor the indexed count back toward its 821 peak.

PHASE 1 Repair the title layer

Highest return

Weeks 1–2

- Fix the system that **truncates titles at 50 characters** and eliminate the duplicated brand suffix.
- Rewrite the **12 truncated titles**, incorporating each page's target search term.
- Fill the **3 empty titles** and rewrite descriptions across the merchandising cluster.
- **Estimated return: $\approx$ +500 visits/month (+10% of total traffic), with no new content created.**

PHASE 2 Convert near-miss rankings

Weeks 2–4

- **"retail customer experience"** (2,900/mo, position #4) is currently answered by the wrong article. The largest single opportunity on the site.
- **Zero-difficulty terms sitting at positions 11–12** that need only title and internal-link adjustments.
- Rebuild internal links to pages orphaned by the content cleanup.

PHASE 3 Reduce brand dependence

Weeks 4–8

- Consolidate the brand-ambassador articles to push the service page toward the Top 10 on an **18,000-searches/month** term.
- Complete the cleanup of non-performing content.

- Target: lift non-branded traffic from 22% to 35%.

PHASE 4 Hygiene and defense

Ongoing

- File the **disavow of spam links** with Google. *This is preventive hygiene, not growth — Google already discounts most of these links.*
- Image alt text, missing descriptions, and JavaScript errors.
- **AI answer optimization:** the search terms that lost traffic are definitional — precisely the queries absorbed by Google's AI-generated summaries.

OBJECTIVES

90-day targets · November 5, 2026

METRIC	TODAY	TARGET	VIA
Monthly organic traffic	5,008	6,500	Phases 1–2
Non-branded traffic share	22%	35%	Phase 3
Keywords in Top 3	191	240	Phases 1–2
Ranking keywords	429	500	Phases 2–3
Technical Health Score	70	85+	Phase 0
Domain Rating	43	43–45	Not forced

Targets are projections based on Ahrefs estimated traffic and the click-through recovery expected once titles are corrected. They will be recalibrated once Search Console data is confirmed.

REQUIREMENTS

What's needed to execute

ACCESS OR DECISION	NEEDED FOR	OWNER
Google Search Console	Validate the diagnosis against real clicks before committing effort	In progress
WPCode on production	Fix the title system and activate the H1 snippet — <i>blocks Phase 1</i>	Pending
WP Engine / Cloudflare admin	Unblock Google's crawlers	Pending

Decision point

Without Search Console and WPCode access, **Phase 1 — the highest-return work — cannot be executed**. The infrastructure fixes requested on July 15 remain open and are holding back the recovery.

Methodology. Ahrefs traffic figures are modeled estimates, not measured clicks; Search Console and GA4 are the source of truth and will be integrated to close the measurement loop. All month-over-month comparisons use snapshots taken on the 5th of each month at identical scope settings.

Keyword analysis covers the top 100 of 429 terms (≈91% of traffic); the long tail is unexamined. The branded/non-branded split was classified manually, as Ahrefs' automatic classification proved unreliable for this domain.

The 21% year-over-year decline has several simultaneous causes — broken titles, blocked crawlers, content consolidation and pressure from AI-generated answers — and should not be attributed to any single one.

Prepared August 5, 2026 · Data: Ahrefs API v3 and direct inspection of 61 ranking pages.